

# Amazon ML Challenge 2026

## Before You Register for ML Challenge 2026: AWS Setup Guide

### Step 1 — Create your AWS Builder ID (before registering)

Your AWS Builder ID is a free personal credential. You will need it to get your alias, which is required to register.

1. Go to [builder.aws.com](https://builder.aws.com) and click Sign in
2. Enter your email → Next
3. Enter your name → Next
4. Enter the verification code sent to your email → Verify (check spam if you do not see it)
5. Set a password, complete the CAPTCHA if shown → Create AWS Builder ID
6. On first sign-in, you will be asked to choose an alias

**Already have a Builder ID?** If you have used AWS Skill Builder or AWS re:Post before, sign in with your existing credentials — no need to create a new one.

**Where to find your alias:** Sign in → click your name (top navigation) → Manage Profile. Your profile link is: [builder.aws.com/community/@youralias](https://builder.aws.com/community/@youralias)

### Step 2 — Verify your student status (before registering)

7. Sign in to [builder.aws.com](https://builder.aws.com)
8. Go to [Edit Profile → Student Details](#)
9. Click Start Verification and follow the steps from SheerID (verification partner) — provide your institution name and enrollment details, and upload a document if prompted
10. **Claim your student rewards on [Builder Center](#) worth \$579- AWS credits, \$100 certification voucher, 12 months of premium Skill Builder**

#### How long does it take?

- Most students finish in a few minutes
- If SheerID asks for extra documents (class schedule / enrollment letter), verification usually completes within 24–48 hours

**If verification is rejected:** Try again with a clearer document or current enrollment proof. Still stuck? Contact [SheerID Support](#).

#### Now Register on Unstop

Once you have your Builder alias, register for Amazon ML Challenge 2026 on Unstop.

- Enter your AWS Builder profile link (builder.aws.com/community/@youralias) in the registration form
- The link is verified during registration — **an invalid link means your registration will not be complete**
- All team members must have a valid Builder alias

### **Step 3 — Set up AWS Free Tier to access your \$200 credits (after registering)**

After registering, create your AWS Free Tier account to unlock your compute credits for the hackathon.

11. Go to [aws.amazon.com/free](https://aws.amazon.com/free) and click Create an AWS Account
12. During sign-up, choose the Free plan
13. You will receive up to \$200 in AWS credits — \$100 on sign-up + up to \$100 more as you explore AWS services

#### **What your credits unlock (per account):**

- Amazon SageMaker — 250 hrs (ml.t3.medium notebook) + 50 hrs training
- Amazon S3 — 5 GB storage, 20,000 GET & 2,000 PUT requests/month
- Access to 30+ always-free AWS services

 **Check your credit balance:** AWS Console → Billing & Cost Management → Free Tier